in his religious views, which prompted Edward Terry, an Anglican at his court, to say that at the Padshah's court, 'all religions are tolerated'. He continued to patronize the family of Shaikh Salim Chishti, he was devoted to the hermit Jadrup, and he allowed three sons of Daniyal to be baptized, to the abiding delight of the Jesuits, though within four years the boys had reconverted to Islam. Many of the symbols Jahangir continued to use were derived from Akbar's notion of sacred kingship, such as the halos he was always painted with, and the Sufi pirs he assiduously courted.

Akbar's extreme experiments with the orthodox tenets of Islam were bound to provoke a backlash, and it was during Jahangir's reign that a certain disgruntled element began to coalesce. The Naqshbandi saints who had lived in Hindustan during Akbar's reign felt keenly their lack of influence and prestige with the Padshah and the nobility, especially when compared with the spectacular success of the Chishti pirs, and the past glory of the Naqshbandi lineage in Central Asia. Naqshbandi thinkers such as Khwaja Baqi-Billah and his disciple Shaikh Ahmad Sirhindi launched a determined attack on the Hindustani Chishti pirs, accusing them of distorting the message of the Prophet. According to these men, there could be no foolish attempt to abandon the sharia or to seek unity between believers and infidels. There were noblemen at court who were seduced by this message, including Mirza Aziz Koka, Shaikh Farid, Qulic Khan, and even Abdur Rahim. In a letter to Aziz Koka, Shaikh Sirhindi wrote that 'the degradation of Islam has reached a stage that infidels mock Islam and its followers, and without let or hindrance celebrate their own pagan rites in bazars, whereas Muslims are restrained from the observance of their religious law'. He was critical of many of Akbar's rules, such as the prohibition of cow slaughter, seeing in them an attack on the religious freedom of Muslims.

According to historian Irfan Habib, it was not only a desire to purify Islam but a seething malaise and resentment at the way non-Muslims were treated that drove men like Shaikh Sirhindi. Wrote the shaikh: 'The glory of Islam consists in the humiliation of infidelity and the Infidels. Anyone who held an Infidel in esteem caused humiliation to Islam. Holding in esteem does not simply mean that one pays respect to them or seats them in a higher position: giving a place to them in one's company, sitting and talking with them, all are means of showing esteem. They (the infidels) should be kept at a distance like dogs.' In fact the real purpose of the imposition of